

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ J T 5
♥ K T 7 6
♦ Q J 3
♣ T 4 3

12
7 10
11

♠ A Q 8 6 2
♥ J 5 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 2



♠ K 9 7 3
♥ 8 4 2
♦ A K 5
♣ J 7 6

♠ 4
♥ A Q 9
♦ T 9 8 6 2
♣ A 9 8 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
All Pass			
3 ♠ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 17

SOUTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding.

But when NORTH opens 1 ♠ SOUTH should show her "almost opening strength"

by jumping to 3 ♠.

NORTH has just 13 points, and knowing SOUTH has less than 13 he passes.

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 7 3
♥ Q 8 6 4 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ K 9 5

10
9 14
7

♠ A K Q J 9 6 4
♥ -
♦ 3 2
♣ T 8 4 2

N
W E
S

♠ 5
♥ J T 9
♦ J T 9 7 4
♣ A J 7 3

♠ T 8 2
♥ A K 7 5 3
♦ K Q 5
♣ Q 6

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass

4♥
All Pass
4♥ by East

instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens

with you should just jump right to game.

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After EAST opens with 1

♥

, WEST has a small "dilemma".

With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3

♥

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But, with five trumps the hand deserves more.
So she just bids 4

♥

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 6 4
♥ Q T 8 3
♦ T 4 2
♣ 7 5

19
6 8
7

♠ Q J 7 5
♥ A
♦ A K Q 3
♣ K T 6 2



♠ K T 8 3
♥ J 7 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ Q J 3

♠ 2
♥ K 9 6 5 4
♦ J 7 5
♣ A 9 8 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♦	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game.

She bids 4 ♠.

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 19

NORTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start

with 1

♦

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SOUTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit

so he responds 1 ♠.

NORTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 7 4
 ♥ K Q 2
 ♦ A J 6
 ♣ 9 3

7
 16 9
 8

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ A T 6 3
 ♦ K 8 3 2
 ♣ 8 7



♠ A
 ♥ J 9 8
 ♦ T 9 5 4
 ♣ Q J T 5 2

♠ T 9 6 3
 ♥ 7 5 4
 ♦ Q 7
 ♣ A K 6 4

West

1 ♠

3 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

North

Pass

Pass

East

2 ♠

4 ♠

South

Pass

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NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

WEST has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1 ♠ rather than 1NT.

EAST isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2 ♠.

WEST has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3 ♠.

EAST has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4 ♠.